PROJECT LEDGERLINE · DOCUMENT 2 OF 3

Business Plan Blueprint

Ledgerline Bank: a fictional UAE digital bank for salaried expats, and the products, rules, people and numbers the platform runs on

Version	1.0 · baseline for v1
Date	Monday 9 November 2026 · day 9 of the 90-day arc
Owner	Lake · CEO
Purpose	Give the synthetic bank a believable business: products, prices, personas, rules and KPIs
Used by	Technical Blueprint (rules BR-01 to BR-14), the synthetic data generator, the Power BI report
Name	“Ledgerline” is a working name. Rename it freely; it is your bank.

In one sentence: Ledgerline Bank is where a salaried expat's money lands, goes out and grows, run with the controls of a real bank.

Fictional by design. Ledgerline Bank is not a real bank, product or offer, and nothing here is financial advice. Every customer and transaction is synthetic. Market facts are cited; every price, rate, salary band and volume is an illustrative assumption for the simulation.

Contents

1. Executive summary . . . 2
2. Why this market . . . 2
3. Customers and personas . . . 3
4. Products and pricing (v1) . . . 3
5. How the bank makes money . . . 4
6. Operating model . . . 4
7. Business rules . . . 5
8. KPIs and the management report . . . 6
9. Regulation and risk: modelled, not claimed . . . 6
10. Roadmap as business milestones . . . 7
11. The synthetic market: generator configuration . . . 7
12. Traceability . . . 7
13. Open decisions for the CEO . . . 8

1. Executive summary

Ledgerline Bank is a fictional, app-only bank for salaried expats in the UAE. It earns a place in a customer's life the way real salary banks do: the salary lands here, everyday money goes out from here, and savings grow here. v1 opens with a salary account and Goal Savings, with a debit card as a stretch, plus the operations, controls and management information a real bank needs from day one.

This document has three jobs

1. Give the synthetic data a believable business: personas, salaries, outflows and prices.
2. Define the business rules (BR-01 to BR-14) that the Technical Blueprint implements and tests.
3. Define what management must be able to see: the KPIs that shape the gold tables and the report.

At a glance	Ledgerline Bank
Customer	Salaried expats in the UAE whose employers pay through the Wage Protection System (WPS)
Promise	Your salary, your bills and your savings in one honest app. No fees on everyday banking.
v1 products	Salary account · Goal Savings · payments out · debit card (stretch)
How it earns (illustrative)	Margin on deposits, card interchange (stretch), a small number of scheduled fees
Simulated scale	2,000 customers · six months of history · AED
Success looks like	A balanced ledger every day, zero unexplained breaks, and a clear cash-flow picture of every customer

2. Why this market

Four facts about the UAE shape the design. They are cited at the end of this document; everything after this section is an assumption.

Fact	Why it matters for Ledgerline
Salaries move electronically through WPS. The system was introduced in 2009, and wages are transferred through banks, exchange houses and licensed financial institutions that take part in it.	The salary credit is the anchor of the relationship and a clean monthly data signal. Every salary arrives as a WPS file line (BR-03).
Digital banking is mainstream. Licensed digital banks such as Wio, Zand and ruya sit alongside digital brands of established banks, such as Liv (Emirates NBD) and Mashreq Neo.	Customers expect app-only onboarding, instant transfers and goal-based savings. Ledgerline is a learning model in that mould, not a competitor.
Account opening is identity-led. Digital accounts are opened with a valid Emirates ID.	KYC status is a first-class field and the gate to account opening (BR-01). Identity data lives only in the pii schema.
The dirham is pegged. It has been fixed at 3.6725 to the US dollar since November 1997, and the UAE central bank typically follows US Federal Reserve rate moves.	v2 investing in US-listed securities converts at a fixed rate, which keeps FX simple. Deposit margins move with US policy (section 5).

> **Why the UAE:** it is where the CEO is aiming his next role. A bank modelled on this market makes the portfolio speak the employer's language: WPS, Emirates ID, AED, CBUAE.

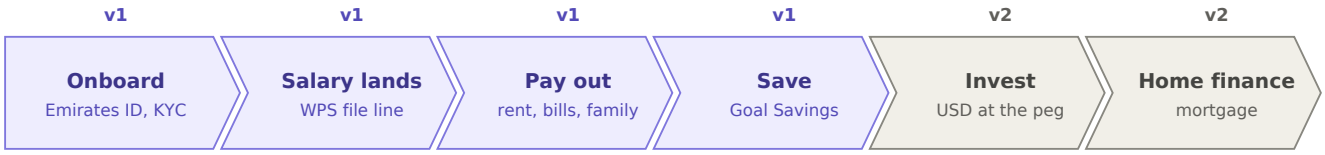
3. Customers and personas

Personas describe how money moves, not who people are. They become the generator's segments, so every chart in the report has real variety behind it.

Persona	Share	Salary (AED/month)	Money behaviour	What they want
Starter	30%	4,000 – 8,000	New to the UAE, first local account; spends most of the salary; small, irregular savings; some money sent home	Fast onboarding, no fees, clarity
Builder	35%	8,000 – 20,000	Mid-career; moves a fixed amount to savings on payday; steady bills	Goal savings that pay interest
Provider	20%	6,000 – 15,000	Supports family abroad; a large payment out within days of payday; thin savings	Predictable cash flow, low costs
Investor	15%	20,000 – 50,000	High savings rate and idle balances; asks for market access	Interest now, investing later (v2)

Shares and salary bands are synthetic assumptions chosen to create varied cash-flow patterns. They are not market statistics.

The customer journey



The first four steps are v1. Investing and home finance arrive in v2, on a platform that already works.

4. Products and pricing (v1)

Product	What it does	Price (illustrative)	Rules
Salary account CURRENT_AED	Receives the WPS salary; hub for transfers, payments out and the card	No monthly fee, no minimum balance, no interest	BR-02 to BR-05
Goal Savings SAVINGS_AED	Up to three named goals; instant moves in and out	2.50% a year, accrued daily (ACT/365), paid monthly	BR-06, BR-11
Payments out	Pay rent, utilities, telecom, school fees or family abroad from the salary account	Free	BR-05
Debit card (stretch)	Pay in shops and online from the salary account	Free; replacement AED 25	BR-08, BR-09

Later, not now

- **Invest (v2):** a USD investment account funded from AED at the peg; flat commission of USD 1 per trade (illustrative).
- **Home finance (v2):** mortgages with amortisation schedules, rate resets and arrears.
- **Parking lot (not committed):** an international remittance product, Sharia-compliant savings, family accounts.

> **Products are data, not code.** These rows become seed data in core.product, core.product_rate and core.fee_schedule. Changing the savings rate is a maker-checker approval with a future effective date, never a code release (BR-11).

Worked example: one month of interest

A Builder keeps AED 20,000 in Goal Savings for a 30-day month at 2.50% a year.

Step	Calculation	Result
Daily accrual	20,000 × 2.50% ÷ 365, kept to six decimal places	AED 1.369863
Month total	1.369863 × 30	AED 41.095890
Paid to the customer	Rounded half away from zero, to the fils	AED 41.10
Carried forward	41.095890 − 41.10, added to next month's total	−AED 0.004110

Reconciliation R4 proves this every month for every account: accruals plus the opening remainder equal the amount paid plus the closing remainder.

5. How the bank makes money

Ledgerline earns mainly by placing customer deposits with the central bank and in high-quality liquid assets, and paying savers less than it earns. Because the dirham is pegged, both rates move with US policy, so management watches the margin rather than the rate level.

Revenue line	Driver	Illustrative assumption
Net interest income	Placement yield on all deposits, minus interest paid on savings	Placement yield 3.75% a year; savings 2.50%; salary accounts pay 0%
Card interchange (stretch)	Card spending × interchange rate	0.50% of spend
Fees	Fee events × fee	Card replacement AED 25
Costs	People, cloud, card scheme, compliance	Not modelled in v1

Worked example: one Builder, one month

Line	Calculation	AED
Salary account float	4,000 × 3.75% ÷ 12	12.50
Savings margin	20,000 × (3.75% − 2.50%) ÷ 12	20.83
Card interchange (stretch)	3,500 × 0.50%	17.50
Revenue before costs		**50.83**

> Estimated net interest income appears on the Bank overview page. It is driven by a single configurable placement-yield parameter and labelled as an estimate everywhere it appears.

6. Operating model

A bank is people running controls. Ledgerline models five teams, each mapped to a system role.

Team	System role	Day to day	Sees personal data?
Customer service	CUSTOMER_SERVICE	Onboarding, freezes and unfreezes, card blocks, customer queries	Yes (BR-12)
Operations	OPERATIONS	Monitors end of day, works the breaks register, proposes reversals (maker)	No, tokens only
Risk and compliance	RISK	Approves sensitive changes (checker), reviews the audit trail, watches frozen accounts	No, tokens only
Finance	Report access	Interest expense, estimated net interest income, deposit trends	No
Admin	ADMIN	Users and roles; product setup (maker)	Yes

The daily rhythm

When (Dubai)	What happens	Owner
00:00	Business day closes. End of day runs: cut-off, interest, month end, clearing settlement, trial balance, roll	System, monitored by Operations
00:30	Pipeline: extract, dbt build, reconciliations R2 to R4, breaks register	System
08:30	Breaks review: every new break gets an owner (BR-14)	Operations
10:00	Approvals queue: pending changes reviewed by a checker	Risk and compliance
Before next EOD	HIGH breaks resolved or formally accepted	Operations with Risk

7. Business rules

Fourteen rules, each implemented in the Technical Blueprint and proven by a test, a trap or a reconciliation. Section references point to the Technical Blueprint.

ID	Rule	Implemented in	Proven by
BR-01	**KYC first.** An account opens only for a customer whose KYC status is PASSED.	Open account (§8)	Database test
BR-02	**Salary account first.** One salary account per customer; up to three Goal Savings accounts, each needing an open salary account.	Open account (§8)	Domain and database tests
BR-03	**Salary credits.** Salaries arrive as WPS file lines and are credited on the day received; a line delivered twice is credited once.	Salary key SAL-{file}-{line} (§7.6)	Trap T9
BR-04	**Own-account transfers.** Instant and free; above zero and at most AED 50,000; no overdrafts.	Posting engine (§7.3); INV-03, INV-04	Traps T1, T2, T6
BR-05	**Payments out.** To a named beneficiary with a category; at most AED 50,000; no overdrafts; they leave through a clearing account settled at end of day.	Payment out (§8); R5	Trap T6; R5
BR-06	**Savings interest.** Accrues daily on the end-of-day balance at the rate effective that day (ACT/365); paid on the last day of the month, rounded to the fils, remainder carried.	End of day steps 2 and 3 (§9)	Traps T3, T10; R4
BR-07	**Frozen accounts.** Cannot be debited but can still receive credits; every freeze and unfreeze is audited.	Posting engine; INV-05	Trap T5
BR-08	**Fees.** Only fees in the fee schedule may be charged. v1 schedule: card replacement AED 25.	Fee process (§8)	Domain test
BR-09	**Card purchases (stretch).** Debit the salary account immediately; declined if funds are insufficient.	Card process (§8)	Domain test
BR-10	**Corrections.** Mistakes are fixed by reversal journals approved by a second person; nothing is deleted.	Reversal process; INV-02	Trap T8
BR-11	**Price changes.** Rate and fee changes need maker-checker approval and take effect from a future date; no backdating.	Pending changes; INV-07	Trap T7
BR-12	**Data access.** Personal data is visible only to customer service and admin; everyone else works with tokens.	Privacy design (§10)	Pipeline privacy test
BR-13	**End of day.** A business day closes only if the ledger balances; otherwise end of day halts and Operations is alerted.	End of day step 5 (§9); R1	R1
BR-14	**Breaks.** Every reconciliation break gets an owner the day it appears; HIGH breaks are resolved or accepted before the next end of day.	Breaks register (§12)	Operations page

8. KPIs and the management report

North-star metric: primary relationship rate, the share of active customers whose salary was credited at Ledgerline in the last 35 days. In salary banking, the salary is the relationship.

KPI	Definition	Gold source	Page
Primary relationship rate	Customers with a salary credit in the last 35 days ÷ active customers	fct_ledger_entry, dim_customer	1
Total deposits	Sum of closing balances across salary and savings accounts	fct_daily_balance	1
Savings ratio	Savings balances ÷ total deposits	fct_daily_balance	1
Interest expense vs estimated NII	Capitalised interest against placement-yield income	fct_interest, fct_daily_balance	1
Monthly savings rate	Net transfers into savings ÷ salary income	fct_customer_cashflow_monthly	2
Leftover at payday	Balance on the day before the next salary arrives	fct_daily_balance, dim_date	2
Outflows by category	Payments out by category as a share of income	fct_customer_cashflow_monthly	2
Card active rate (stretch)	Card holders with a purchase in the last 30 days ÷ card holders	fct_card_spend	2
EOD on time	End of day finished before 00:30 Dubai time	fct_ops_daily	3
Open breaks by severity and age	Count and age of breaks not yet resolved	recon.break	3
Pipeline freshness	Time since the last successful load	etl.load_audit	3
Data quality pass rate	dbt tests passed ÷ tests run	dbt run results	3

The three-page report

Page	The question it answers	Visuals
1. Bank overview	Are we growing, and what does it cost?	Deposits trend; savings ratio; primary relationship rate; interest expense against estimated NII
2. Customers and cash flow	How healthy are our customers' finances?	Income, outflows and leftover by persona; savings-rate distribution; the payday cycle
3. Operations and controls	Can we trust today's numbers?	EOD status; breaks by severity and age; pipeline freshness; test pass rate

9. Regulation and risk: modelled, not claimed

A real UAE bank needs a licence from the Central Bank of the UAE (CBUAE) and must meet obligations covering anti-money-laundering and sanctions, customer identification, consumer protection, data protection, outsourcing and operational resilience. Ledgerline claims compliance with none of these. It models the controls those obligations depend on, so the data has realistic shapes.

Area	Modelled in v1	Not modelled
Identity and KYC	KYC status gates account opening (BR-01); synthetic Emirates ID-style identifiers kept in pii	Document checks, screening services
Financial crime	Audit trail; account freezes (BR-07)	Transaction monitoring, sanctions screening (a v3 idea)
Segregation of duties	Maker-checker (BR-10, BR-11); staff roles	Nothing material
Data protection	Personal-data split, tokenisation, least privilege (BR-12)	Data residency evidence, consent management

Area	Modelled in v1	Not modelled
Financial control	Daily trial balance, reconciliations, breaks register (BR-13, BR-14)	Regulatory returns
Operational resilience	Idempotent re-runs, batch logs	Disaster recovery, failover

10. Roadmap as business milestones

Stage	Window	Business milestone	Platform
Open for business	Days 10–40, to Thu 10 Dec 2026	Salary account, Goal Savings, payments out, daily controls, management report	v1
Grow wallet share	Days 41–70, to Sat 9 Jan 2027	Invest in USD at the peg; home finance	v2
Get smarter	Days 71–90, to Fri 29 Jan 2027 (optional)	Cash-flow credit insight, multi-currency, real-time events	v3

Parking lot, not committed: remittance product, Sharia-compliant savings, family accounts, merchant insights from card descriptors.

11. The synthetic market: generator configuration

Every assumption above becomes one configuration file. Change the business and the data changes with it.

```
# generator/config.yaml  -  synthetic assumptions, not market data
bank:
  currency: AED
  history_start: 2026-05-01        # six months of business dates
  months: 6
  customers: 2000
  seed: 42
personas:                          # share of customers; monthly salary in AED
  starter:  {share: 0.30, salary: [4000, 8000],   save_rate: [0.00, 0.05], send_home: [0.05, 0.20]}
  builder:  {share: 0.35, salary: [8000, 20000],  save_rate: [0.10, 0.20], send_home: [0.00, 0.10]}
  provider: {share: 0.20, salary: [6000, 15000],  save_rate: [0.00, 0.05], send_home: [0.30, 0.50]}
  investor: {share: 0.15, salary: [20000, 50000], save_rate: [0.25, 0.40], send_home: [0.00, 0.10]}
salary:
  channel: WPS
  payday_window: [-3, 1]           # three days before month end, to the 1st
payments_out:                      # shares of salary, scaled to fit income
  rent:      {share: [0.25, 0.40], days: [1, 5]}
  utilities: {share: [0.03, 0.06], days: [5, 15]}
  telecom:   {share: [0.01, 0.03], days: [10, 20]}
  school:    {share: [0.00, 0.15], days: [1, 10]}
  other:     {share: [0.10, 0.25], pattern: daily}
  # send_home becomes REMITTANCE payments within days of payday
pricing:
  savings_rate: 0.025
  placement_yield: 0.0375          # estimated NII only
  transfer_limit: 50000
card:                              # stretch: replaces part of "other"
  categories: {groceries: 0.30, dining: 0.20, transport: 0.15, shopping: 0.20, bills: 0.15}
traps: [T1, T2, T3, T4, T5, T6, T7, T8, T9, T10]
```

12. Traceability

How each business need is met and proven. This is the table a business analyst would walk a stakeholder through.

Business need	Rules	Platform component	Proof
Salary-led relationship	BR-02, BR-03	Salary credit with WPS line keys	Trap T9; primary relationship KPI
Money never lost or duplicated	BR-04, BR-05, BR-10	Posting engine, idempotency keys, reversals	Traps T1, T2, T6, T8; R1

Business need	Rules	Platform component	Proof
Savings pay exactly what we promise	BR-06, BR-11	Accrual, capitalisation, rate schedule	Traps T3, T10; R4
Customer data protected	BR-12	Personal-data split, token vault, roles	Pipeline privacy test
Numbers management can trust	BR-13, BR-14	End-of-day controls, R1 to R5, breaks register	Operations and controls page
Controls a regulator would expect	BR-01, BR-07, BR-10, BR-11	KYC gate, freezes, maker-checker, audit trail	Traps T5, T7

13. Open decisions for the CEO

Four calls this plan makes on your behalf. Each is reversible today and expensive later, so tick one box per row before the build starts.

Decision	Recommendation	Why	Your call
Market framing	A fictional UAE digital bank in AED (Technical Blueprint ADR-016)	Matches the UAE job target; the dollar peg keeps v2 investing simple	☐ Agree ☐ Change
Payments out in v1	Yes, simplified: categorised, settled through a clearing account (ADR-019)	Without outflows, balances only grow and every cash-flow KPI is meaningless	☐ Agree ☐ Change
Debit card	Stretch in v1; first item of v2 if time runs out	Rich merchant data, but payments out already cover cash flow	☐ Agree ☐ Change
The bank's name	Keep “Ledgerline” as the working name	Rename any time before the README and demo video	☐ Keep ☐ Rename

Sources

- Gulf News, the UAE's Wages Protection System explained: https://gulfnews.com/living-in-uae/ask-us/the-uaes-wages-protection-system-wps-explained-1.1606915278015
- Gulf News, UAE salary rules: WPS transfers via banks, exchange houses and licensed institutions: https://gulfnews.com/uae/uae-salary-rule-changes-from-june-1-what-workers-and-employers-must-know-1.500558533
- StashAway, digital banks in the UAE (2026): https://www.stashaway.ae/r/uae-digital-banks
- Belong, digital banks in the UAE (2026): https://getbelong.com/blog/digital-banks-uae/
- Gulf News, creation, history and evolution of the UAE dirham: https://gulfnews.com/amp/story/uae%2Fyear-of-the-50th%2Fcreation-history-and-evolution-of-the-uae-dirham-1.1621767243152
- The National, why the dirham is pegged to the US dollar: https://www.thenationalnews.com/lifestyle/2024/11/22/uae-dirham-dollar-peg